

Thalassemia Research Questionnaire

Part A – Basic Information

1. Age (What was your age at last birthday?):

2. Gender:

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female

3. Ethnicity:

- ☐ Sinhalese
- ☐ Tamil
- ☐ Moors
- ☐ Burger
- ☐ Other (please specify):

Enter ethnicity here

4. Religion

- ☐ Buddhist
- ☐ Hindu
- ☐ Christian
- ☐ Roman Catholic
- ☐ Islamic
- ☐ Other (please specify)

Enter religion here

5. Occupation:

- ☐ Government sector
- ☐ Private sector
- ☐ Self-employed
- ☐ Not employed

6. Monthly Income (LKR):

- ☐ < 25,000
- ☐ 25,000 – 50,000
- ☐ 51,000 – 100,000
- ☐ > 100,000

7. Education Level:

- ☐ Up to O/L
- ☐ Up to A/L
- ☐ Undergraduate
- ☐ Graduate
- ☐ Postgraduate

8. Residing Province:

- ☐ Northern
- ☐ Southern
- ☐ Western
- ☐ Eastern
- ☐ Central
- ☐ North Central
- ☐ North Western
- ☐ Sabaragamuwa
- ☐ Uva

9. Marital Status

- ☐ Married
- ☐ Single

10. Do you have children?

- ☐ Yes, only one child
- ☐ Yes, more than one child
- ☐ No children

11. Do you have a family history of an inherited blood disorder?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

12. If yes, please specify

13. When were you diagnosed as a carrier? (Year):

14. Where were you diagnosed as a thalassemia carrier?

- ☐ During school/university
- ☐ During community screening
- ☐ At workplace
- ☐ Individual or family screening after a relative was diagnosed
- ☐ Referral by a doctor

Part B – Knowledge on Thalassemia

15. Is thalassemia a blood-related disease?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Don't know

16. What are the clinical forms of thalassemia? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Thalassemia major (severe form)
- ☐ Thalassemia minor or trait (carrier form)
- ☐ Thalassemia intermedia (moderate form)
- ☐ I don't know

17. What is the most severe form of thalassemia?

- ☐ Thalassemia major (severe form)
- ☐ Thalassemia minor or trait (carrier form)
- ☐ Thalassemia intermedia (moderate form)
- ☐ I don't know

18. What form of thalassemia do you have?

- ☐ Thalassemia major (severe form)
- ☐ Thalassemia minor or trait (carrier form)
- ☐ Thalassemia intermedia (moderate form)
- ☐ I don't know

19. Does thalassemia major require lifelong treatment?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Don't know

20. Can thalassemia major be cured?

- ☐ Cannot be cured
- ☐ Very difficult (e.g., bone marrow transplant)
- ☐ Can be cured with common treatments
- ☐ Don't know

21. Can the spread of thalassemia be prevented?

- ☐ Cannot be prevented
- ☐ Can be prevented
- ☐ Not sure

22. How is thalassemia transmitted?

- ☐ From generation to generation (hereditary)
- ☐ Randomly
- ☐ As a contagious disease
- ☐ Due to environmental factors
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Don't know

23. Is a thalassemia carrier usually sick or healthy?

- ☐ Not healthy
- ☐ Healthy
- ☐ Don't know

24. A child born from two thalassemia carriers will be:

- ☐ Always healthy
- ☐ Always affected by thalassemia
- ☐ Has a chance to be affected (e.g., 25%)
- ☐ Don't know

25. After diagnosis, was counseling/information sufficient?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

26. How many thalassemia births occur in Sri Lanka per year?

- ☐ 40–100
- ☐ Much less than this (<40)
- ☐ More than this (>100)
- ☐ Don't know

27. Problems faced by thalassemia major patients (Tick all that apply):

- ☐ Regular blood transfusions for life
- ☐ Iron overload affecting heart and liver
- ☐ Delayed growth and puberty
- ☐ Risk of diabetes, infertility, and hormonal issues
- ☐ Risk of infections from transfusions
- ☐ Frequent nosebleeds
- ☐ Fatigue
- ☐ Bone deformities

28. What should a thalassemia carrier do after diagnosis? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Get the partner tested before marriage
- ☐ Get family members tested
- ☐ Ignore it
- ☐ I don't know

29. How did you learn about thalassemia?

- ☐ School
- ☐ Mass media (TV, newspapers, social media)
- ☐ Healthcare staff (doctors and nurses)
- ☐ Family
- ☐ Only found out after screening

30. Are you willing to / Do you have a consanguineous marriage?

- ☐ Yes I am willing
- ☐ Yes I have
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Definitely not

31. Do you accept marriage between two thalassemia carriers?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

32. How important is thalassemia screening before marriage?

- ☐ Very important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Not important

33. What was your practice of partner screening?

- ☐ Did not screen partner
- ☐ Partner was screened before marriage
- ☐ Partner was screened after marriage
- ☐ Partner was screened during pregnancy
- ☐ Did not disclose thalassemia carrier state to partner
- ☐ Other

If other please specify

34. If you did not disclose your carrier status to your partner before marriage, what was the reason?

- ☐ Fear of rejection
- ☐ Lack of understanding about its importance
- ☐ Cultural or family pressure
- ☐ Did not think it was necessary
- ☐ Concern about causing worry or stress
- ☐ Other

If other please specify

Part D – Attitudes & Practices Regarding Family Screening

35. Do you think is it important for your family members to undergo screening?

- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Don't know

36. Do your family members know your thalassemia status?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

37. To what extent have your relatives undergone screening?

All

Some

None

Don't know

First-degree relatives (parents, siblings, children):

☐☐☐☐

Second-degree relatives (grandparents, uncles, aunts):

☐☐☐☐

Third-degree relatives (cousins, etc.):

☐☐☐☐

38. If not screened, what were the reasons? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Lack of knowledge
- ☐ Concern about stigma or discrimination
- ☐ Fear of result
- ☐ Perception that screening was unnecessary
- ☐ Cost or access issues
- ☐ Other

If other please specify

39. How easy is it to convince relatives to undergo screening?

- ☐ Very easy
- ☐ Somewhat easy
- ☐ Difficult
- ☐ Not sure

40. How important is cascade screening in thalassemia prevention?

- ☐ Very important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Slightly important
- ☐ Not important